

Sony LinkBuds Fit

A smart fit for everyday listening

Sony's LinkBuds series has always been about rethinking TWS audio. The original LinkBuds broke conventions with their open-ring design meant for all-day wear and ambient awareness. The new LinkBuds Fit takes a more traditional approach, but with the same underlying philosophy of comfort and adaptability at their core.

Now priced at ₹18,990 in India, the LinkBuds Fit slot themselves into a premium but not quite flagship tier, sitting comfortably between the more accessible mid-range options and Sony's own high-end WF-1000XM5. But in a market brimming with choices ranging from Samsung's Galaxy Buds series to Apple's AirPods, can the LinkBuds Fit carve out a space of their own? Are they truly versatile enough to handle everything from daily commutes to intense workout sessions, without compromising on comfort or sound quality?

DESIGN, BUILD AND FIT

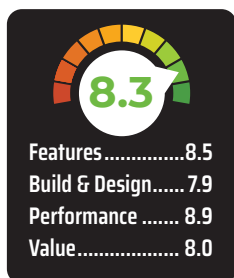
Sony's LinkBuds Fit brings a neat, approachable design to the table. The case stands out with its smooth, pebble-like form and a two-tier finish.

The bottom half, which tends to bear the brunt of everyday use, has a matte texture that feels durable, while the top half adds a glossy touch, which is subtle but also adds a flair.

The earbuds themselves are lightweight and comfortable, with silicone support wings that help them stay securely in place. The fit is snug without being tight, making them easy to wear for long stretches without discomfort. This design also helps the noise cancellation work more effectively, which is always a plus.

I found the default ear tips just right, but Sony includes additional sizes in

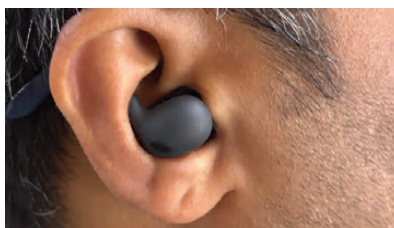
₹18,990



the box to help you get that proper seal. The secure fit should appeal to runners and active users who need earbuds that won't shift or fall out during movement.

In terms of durability, the LinkBuds Fit come with an IPX4 rating,

which means they can handle splashes and sweat. This is fine for a workout session or a walk in light rain. That said, there are more rugged options out there, like the Jaybird Vista 2, which might be better suited for more demanding outdoor activities.



FEATURES

Sony has packed the LinkBuds Fit with some thoughtful features that make a lot of sense. To ensure that these over-the-top enhancements work smoothly, Sony employs its integrated V2 Processor that's also used on the high-end Sony WF-1000XM5. You can control these features from Sony's Sound Connect App, which has evolved nicely over the years.

Wide Area Tap, for instance, is a clever touch. Instead of fumbling to press tiny controls on the earbuds, you can simply tap the area just in front of your ears to play or pause music, or skip tracks. It feels natural and keeps the buds free of unnecessary taps and smudges. This worked more often than not, but there is room for improvement in terms of consistency.

Then there's Speak-to-Chat which proved very useful. It can automatically pause your music and turn on ambient mode the moment you start speaking, ideal when your hands are full and you need to exchange a quick word with someone. Once the conversation ends, your music resumes without needing any input.

Automatic Noise Cancellation proved useful in office settings and during commutes, handling consistent background noise with decent efficiency. In more unpredictable home environments where sounds vary in type and intensity, it was occasionally less reliable.

Sony also includes support for DSEE (Digital Sound Enhancement Engine), which restores detail in compressed audio files in real time. This helps bring out a bit more richness and clarity, especially in the mids and highs.

There are also a few features that feel a bit experimental, like head gesture controls. You can nod to accept a call or shake your head to dismiss it. While I haven't fully warmed up to using them in everyday scenarios, they're clever additions that some users might find intuitive. Voice control is more familiar territory. Google Assistant and Alexa are built-in, letting you manage playback, send messages, or set reminders without touching your phone. In all, these fea-